# Inheritance

## Polymorphism, Subtyping, Reuse

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Lecture #8 out of 8
80 minutes

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Polymorphism

Implementation Inheritance

Chapter #1:

# Polymorphism

# Liskov Substitution Principle (LSP)

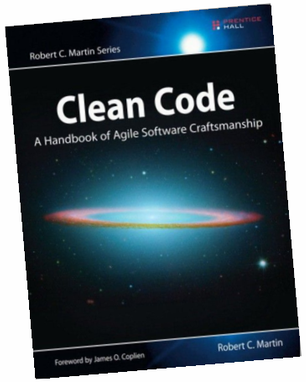


"If for each object $o_1$ of type $S$ there is an object $o_2$ of type $T$ such that for all programs $P$ defined in terms of $T$, the behavior of $P$ is unchanged when $o_1$ is substituted for $o_2$, then $S$ is a subtype of $T$."

— Barbara Liskov. *Keynote Address — Data Abstraction and Hierarchy.* Proceedings of the Object-Oriented Programming Systems, Languages and Applications (Addendum), 1987

[ LSP SOLID Subtyping Generics Overloading ]

# SOLID (the “L” part)



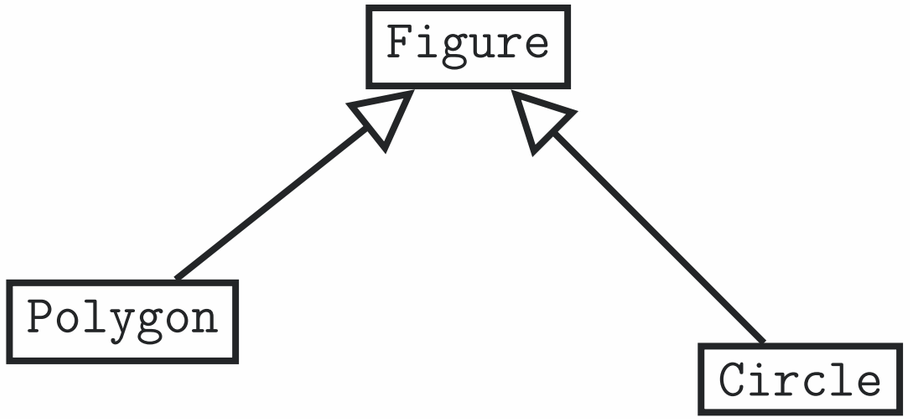



“Functions that use pointers or references to base classes must be able to use objects of derived classes without knowing it.”

— Robert C. Martin. *Clean Code: A Handbook of Agile Software Craftsmanship*. Pearson Education, 2008. DOI: 10.5555/1388398

# Subtyping

```
1  interface Figure
2    float area();
3
4  interface Circle extends Figure
5    float perimeter();
6
7  interface Polygon extends Figure
8    int sides();
9
10 void paint(Figure f)
11   float s = f.area();
12   // ...
```




Circle $\sqsubseteq$ Figure

Circle <: Figure

# Parametric Polymorphism (Generics)

```
1  class StackOfStrings {
2    void push(String str) // ...
3    String pop() // ...
4
5  class StackOfIntegers {
6    void push(Integer num) // ...
7    Integer pop() // ...
8
9  var s1 = new StackOfStrings();
10 s1.push("Hello, world!");
11
12 var s2 = new StackOfIntegers();
13 s2.push(42);
```

```
1  class <T> Stack<T> {
2    void push(T item) // ...
3    T pop() // ...
4  }
5
6  var s1 = new Stack<String>();
7  s1.push("Hello, world!");
8
9  var s2 = new Stack<Integer>();
10 s2.push(42);
```

# Ad Hoc Polymorphism (Method Overloading)

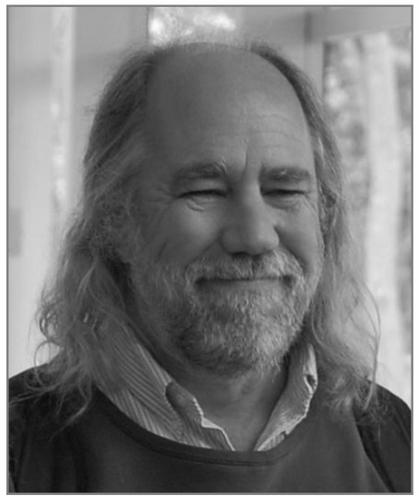
```
1  class Cart {
2    void add(int pid) // ...
3    void addString(String pid) {
4      this.add(Integer.parseInt(pid))
     ;
5    }
6  }
7
8  var c = new Cart();
9  c.add(42);
10 c.addString("17");
11 c.addString("Hello, world!");
```

```
1  class Cart {
2    void add(int pid) // ...
3    void add(String pid) {
4      this.add(Integer.parseInt(pid))
     ;
5    }
6  }
7
8  var c = new Cart();
9  c.add(42);
10 c.add("17");
11 c.add("Hello, world!");
```

Chapter #2:

# Implementation Inheritance

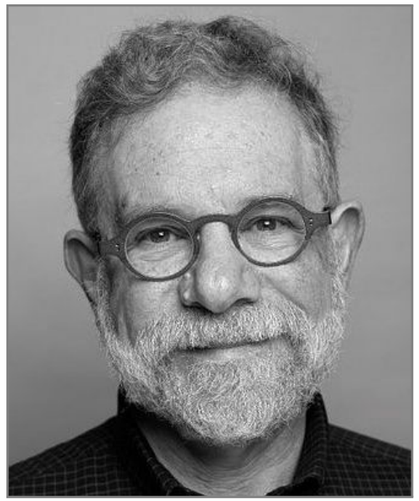


Grady Booch

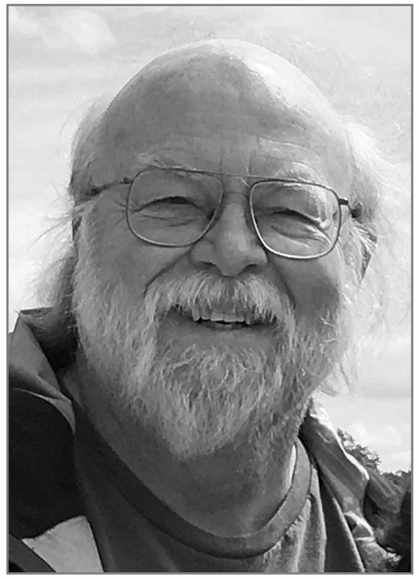
"However, there is tension between the concepts of coupling and inheritance because inheritance introduces significant coupling. On the one hand, weakly coupled classes are desirable; on the other hand, inheritance—which tightly couples superclasses and their subclasses—helps us to exploit the commonality among abstractions."

— Grady Booch et al. *Object-Oriented Analysis and Design With Applications*. Addison-Wesley, 1994. DOI: 10.5555/1407387



"The `extends` keyword is evil; maybe not at the Charles Manson level, but bad enough that it should be shunned whenever possible."

— Allen Holub. *Why Extends Is Evil*. `https://jttu.net/holub2003extends`. [Online; accessed 12-09-2024]. Sept. 2003

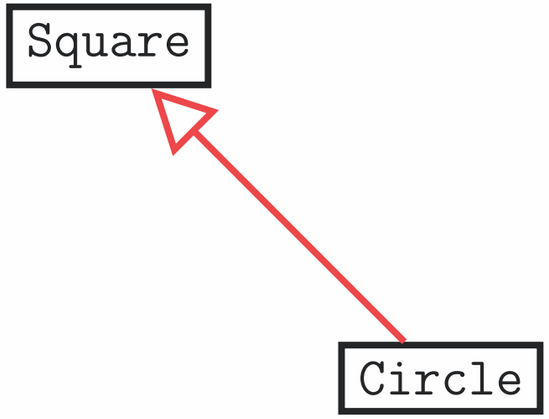


"Someone asked him: "If you could do Java over again, what would you change?" "I'd leave out classes," he replied."

— Allen Holub. *Why Extends Is Evil*. `https://jttu.net/holub2003extends`. [Online; accessed 12-09-2024]. Sept. 2003

# Code Reuse

```
1  class Square
2    private float width;
3    float area()
4      return width * width;
5
6  class Circle extends Square
7    Circle(float radius)
8      super(radius);
9    @Override float area()
10     return 3.14 * super.area();
```




Here, the `Circle` is not a `Square`. It merely reuses the code that was negligently left open in the `Square`.

> Inheriting means “receive (money, property, or a title) as an heir at the death of the previous holder.” Who is dead, you ask? An object is dead if it allows other objects to inherit its encapsulated code and data.

# Composition over Inheritance

Implementation Inheritance:

```
1  class Square
2    private float width;
3    float area()
4      return width * width;
5
6  class Circle extends Square
7    Circle(float radius)
8      super(radius);
9    @Override float area()
10     return 3.14 * super.area();
```

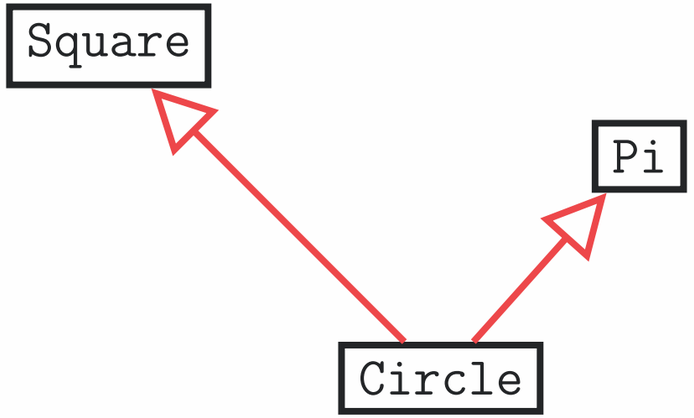
Composition:

```
1  final class Square
2    private float width;
3    float area()
4      return width * width;
5
6  final class Circle
7    private Square s;
8    Circle(float radius)
9      this.s = new Square(radius);
10   float area()
11     return 3.14 * s.area();
```

> All classes, without exceptions, should be either `final` or `abstract`

# Multiple Inheritance

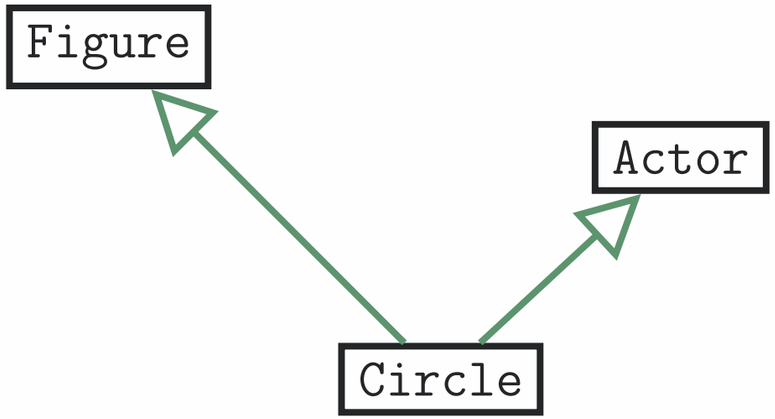
```
1  class Pi
2    float value()
3      return 3.1415926;
4
5  class Square
6    private float width;
7    float area()
8      return width * width;
9
10 class Circle extends Square, Pi
11   Circle(float r): Square(r), Pi()
     {}
12   virtual float area()
13     return Pi.value() * Square.area
     ();
```



[ Reuse Composition Multiple Parents ]

# Multiple Super Types

```
1  interface Actor
2    void move(int dx, int dy);
3
4  interface Figure
5    float area();
6
7  class Circle implements Figure,
     Actor
8    Circle(float r)
9    @Override float area()
10     // ...
11   @Override void move(int dx, int
     dy)
12     // ...
```



[ Reuse Composition Multiple Parents ]

# References

[1] Grady Booch et al. *Object-Oriented Analysis and Design With Applications*. Addison-Wesley, 1994. DOI: 10.5555/1407387.

[2] Allen Holub. *Why Extends Is Evil*. https://jttu.net/holub2003extends. [Online; accessed 12-09-2024]. Sept. 2003.

[3] Barbara Liskov. *Keynote Address — Data Abstraction and Hierarchy*. Proceedings of the Object-Oriented Programming Systems, Languages and Applications (Addendum), 1987.

[4] Robert C. Martin. *Clean Code: A Handbook of Agile Software Craftsmanship*. Pearson Education, 2008. DOI: 10.5555/1388398.